

DOCUMENT CONTROL

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Status	Release
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Layer	Layer 0: Framework Foundation
Parent	None: This is the master root document
Owner	John Goulden
Date	23.04.2026
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Child Documents	EAAP-CORE-001, EAAP-ARCH-001 through EAAP-ARCH-006

Version History

Version / Date	Author	Description
v1.0 23.04.2026	John Goulden	Initial release. Master parent document for the EAAP document hierarchy. Resolves all child document parent references.

Table of Contents

DOCUMENT CONTROL 1

Version History..... 1

Table of Contents 2

1. PURPOSE AND AUTHORITY 3

2. FRAMEWORK IDENTITY 3

3.1 What EAAP includes..... 3

3.2 What EAAP excludes..... 3

4. CORE DEFINITIONS 3

5. ARCHITECTURAL LAYERS 4

5.1 Layer model 4

5.2 Layer descriptions..... 4

6. DOCUMENT HIERARCHY 5

6.1 Document register..... 5

6.2 Parent-child rules 5

7. VERSIONING AND CHANGE CONTROL 5

8. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY DECLARATION 6

9. GOVERNING RULES..... 6

GLOSSARY 7

1. PURPOSE AND AUTHORITY

This document is the master root of the Enterprise AI Architecture Pattern (EAAP) document hierarchy. It establishes the foundational definitions, framework identity, scope boundaries, document register, and governing rules that all child documents must conform to.

All EAAP documents reference this document as their ultimate authority. In any conflict between this document and a child document, this document prevails.

EAAP-DEF-001 is the parent of all EAAP documents. No EAAP document exists outside this hierarchy. No EAAP document may contradict the definitions or governing rules established here.

2. FRAMEWORK IDENTITY

Framework name	Enterprise AI Architecture Pattern
Abbreviation	EAAP
Author and owner	John Goulden
Origin date	March 2026
Current version	v1.0
Framework classification	Proprietary architectural pattern and intellectual property
Deployment reference	EAAP Enterprise AI Platform (reference implementation)
Governing law	Federal Republic of Germany

3. SCOPE OF EAAP

3.1 What EAAP includes

- Abstract architectural principles** The design pattern for modular, governable, vendor-independent enterprise AI systems.
- Orchestration framework** The principles and decision model governing how multiple AI domain agents are coordinated.
- Domain agent model** The structural specification all domain agents must conform to.
- Governance architecture** The structural controls for traceability, auditability, escalation, and human oversight.
- Knowledge integration model** The principles governing how knowledge sources ground agent reasoning.
- Deployment neutrality principles** The requirements for platform-agnostic, air-gappable deployment.
- IP boundary definitions** The precise scope of what constitutes EAAP intellectual property.

3.2 What EAAP excludes

- Individual domain agent implementations** Specific system prompts and agent operating content are implementation artefacts, not framework definitions.
- Customer-specific deployments** Any deployment of EAAP for a specific organisation is outside the abstract framework.
- Enterprise Orchestration Layer** Higher-level inter-agent coordination, meta-agent control logic, and enterprise-wide orchestration remain separate IP unless expressly included by written amendment.
- Executable software components** EAAP is an architectural pattern, not a software product.
- Third-party products** References to specific vendors (Nutanix, VMware, etc.) are implementation examples, not framework components.

4. CORE DEFINITIONS

The following definitions apply across all EAAP documents. Where a child document uses any of these terms, the definition below governs.

Term	Definition
EAAP	Enterprise AI Architecture Pattern. The abstract, proprietary design pattern defined and owned by John Goulden, consisting of the framework documents listed in Section 6.
Domain Agent	A bounded AI reasoning component dedicated to one technical, operational, legal, or business domain. Governed by EAAP-ARCH-001.
Orchestrator	The supervisory reasoning layer that coordinates multiple domain agents, resolves conflicts, assigns confidence, and enforces escalation. Governed by EAAP-ARCH-002 and EAAP-ARCH-003.
Knowledge Layer	The structured knowledge sources that ground domain agent and orchestrator reasoning. Evidence-classified, version-controlled, and locally hosted.
Governance Layer	The structural controls applied across all EAAP layers ensuring traceability, auditability, human oversight, and separation of recommendation from execution.
Automation Gateway	The sole component permitted to interact with target infrastructure systems. Implements plan-approve-execute workflow with deny-by-default access control.
Evidence Class	The classification of the source supporting an agent or orchestrator output: Vendor-Supported, Framework-Supported, Best Practice, Heuristic, or Assumption.
Execution Boundary	The architectural boundary separating AI reasoning from enterprise action. The agent boundary ends at recommendation. Execution requires explicit human approval.
Confidence Level	The assessed reliability of an output: High, Medium, Low, or Unknown. Governed by the confidence model in EAAP-ARCH-003.
Action Risk Tier	The risk classification of a recommended action: Tier 0 (read-only), Tier 1 (low-risk reversible), Tier 2 (disruptive), Tier 3 (destructive).
Data Sufficiency Gate	The mandatory check before domain agent invocation that confirms sufficient input data is available to reason reliably.
Conditional Override	The governance halt triggered when confidence is Low, data is insufficient, or domain conflict is unresolved. No recommendation is issued until the condition is resolved.
Framework Asset	Any document, prompt specification, reasoning workflow, architectural pattern, or design methodology that forms part of the EAAP intellectual property.
Implementation	A specific deployment of EAAP-compatible architecture for a defined environment. Distinct from the abstract framework.
Reference Implementation	The EAAP Enterprise AI Platform. The sole current reference implementation of the EAAP framework.
Productive Use	Any use of the EAAP framework beyond evaluation, including operational deployment, commercial licensing, or integration into products or services.

5. ARCHITECTURAL LAYERS

5.1 Layer model

EAAP is organised into four architectural layers. Each layer has a defined function and interacts with adjacent layers only through controlled interfaces.

Layer	Number	Description	Documents
Framework Foundation	Layer 0	Master definitions, scope, and governing rules.	EAAP-DEF-001
Architecture Pattern	Layer 3	Abstract architectural principles independent of any implementation.	EAAP-CORE-001
Architecture Design	Layer 2	Formal architecture models, decision models, and functional specifications.	EAAP-ARCH-001 through EAAP-ARCH-004, EAAP-ARCH-006
Implementation	Layer 1	Specific deployment designs, technology choices, and production specifications.	EAAP-ARCH-003A, EAAP-ARCH-005

5.2 Layer descriptions

Layer 0: Framework Foundation

This document. Defines the framework identity, master definitions, document hierarchy, and governing rules. No other document supersedes Layer 0.

Layer 3: Architecture Pattern

Defines abstract architectural principles independent of any vendor, infrastructure platform, LLM, or deployment environment. EAAP-CORE-001 lives at this layer. It cannot reference specific products or implementations.

Layer 2: Architecture Design

Defines formal architecture models, decision frameworks, and functional specifications derived from Layer 3 principles. Documents at this layer define how EAAP works but remain platform-neutral.

Layer 1: Implementation

Defines specific deployment designs with named technologies, version numbers, and environment-specific configurations. Documents at this layer describe a specific realisation of the EAAP architecture.

6. DOCUMENT HIERARCHY

6.1 Document register

Document ID	Title	Layer	Status	Parent
EAAP-DEF-001	Framework Definitions & Master Reference	Layer 0	Release	None: Root
EAAP-CORE-001	Core Architecture Definition	Layer 3	Release	EAAP-DEF-001
EAAP-ARCH-001	Domain Agent Model	Layer 2	Release	EAAP-DEF-001
EAAP-ARCH-002	Orchestration Logic	Layer 2	Release	EAAP-DEF-001
EAAP-ARCH-002A	Orchestration Prompt Control	Layer 2	Release	EAAP-ARCH-002
EAAP-ARCH-003	Orchestration Decision Model	Layer 2	Release	EAAP-DEF-001
EAAP-ARCH-003A	Orchestration Decision Model: Production Design	Layer 1	Production Design	EAAP-ARCH-003
EAAP-ARCH-004	Functional Architecture Model	Layer 2	Release	EAAP-DEF-001
EAAP-ARCH-005	Functional Architecture HLD	Layer 1	Draft	EAAP-ARCH-004
EAAP-ARCH-006	Deployment Model: Platform-Agnostic	Layer 2	Release	EAAP-DEF-001

6.2 Parent-child rules

- Every EAAP document must declare a parent document in its Document Control section.
- No document may contradict a definition or governing rule established in a parent document.
- A child document may extend and specialise a parent document’s scope but may not reduce it.
- Version increments of a parent document require review of all child documents for consistency.
- Documents at Layer 1 may reference specific technologies. Documents at Layer 2 and above must remain platform-neutral.

7. VERSIONING AND CHANGE CONTROL

Version increment	Trigger	Approval required
Patch (x.x.N)	Corrections to existing content. No scope change.	Owner review.
Minor (x.N.0)	Addition of new sections or definitions. No structural change.	Owner review and version history update.

Version increment	Trigger	Approval required
Major (N.0.0)	Structural change, scope change, or redefinition of core terms.	Owner review, child document impact assessment, and version history update.

A major version increment of EAAP-DEF-001 requires review and update of all child documents. Child documents must not be published referencing a superseded version of this document without documented justification.

8. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY DECLARATION

The EAAP framework, including all documents in the register defined in Section 6, constitutes pre-existing intellectual property developed independently by John Goulden.

This IP includes but is not limited to:

- **All framework definitions, principles, and governing rules defined in this document.**
- **All architectural models, decision frameworks, and functional specifications in Layer 2 documents.**
- **All orchestration logic, conflict resolution models, and confidence models.**
- **All domain agent structural specifications and governance patterns.**
- **All deployment models, security architectures, and integration patterns.**

Separately and expressly excluded from the present framework: any future-developed Enterprise Orchestration Layer including inter-agent reasoning coordination, supervisory prompt routing, meta-agent control logic, enterprise-wide domain interaction frameworks, and centralized reasoning arbitration mechanisms. These constitute separate intellectual property in development.

9. GOVERNING RULES

The following rules apply to the entire EAAP framework and all documents within it. These rules are non-negotiable and cannot be overridden by child documents.

Rule	Statement
GR-001	All EAAP documents must reference EAAP-DEF-001 as the ultimate authority.
GR-002	No domain agent may be deployed under EAAP without conforming to EAAP-ARCH-001.
GR-003	No multi-agent orchestration may bypass the logic defined in EAAP-ARCH-002 and EAAP-ARCH-003.
GR-004	No Tier 2 or Tier 3 action may be executed without explicit human approval through the Automation Gateway.
GR-005	All outputs must carry evidence classification, confidence level, and risk tier.
GR-006	Governance is structural. It may not be made optional or bypassed by configuration.
GR-007	The execution boundary is absolute. Agents advise. Humans decide. Gateways execute.
GR-008	Low or Unknown confidence blocks all recommendations. Data collection is required before re-invocation.
GR-009	Conflicts between domain agents must be surfaced explicitly. Silent conflict resolution is prohibited.
GR-010	No document outside the register in Section 6.1 may claim to be part of the EAAP framework without written amendment to this document.
GR-011	EAAP governance accountability is bounded to the Deployment Risk domain. AI Model Risk accountability rests with the AI vendor. AI Operational Risk accountability rests with the operating entity. These three accountability domains must be formally assigned, documented, and must not be conflated. An AI deployment may not proceed until all three accountability domains have named owners, the Model Risk Assessment Gate (TBM-D-001) has been completed and signed, and the gate record has been registered in the EAAP audit trail.

GLOSSARY

All terms defined in Section 4 constitute the authoritative EAAP glossary. Child documents may add domain-specific terms but may not redefine terms established here.